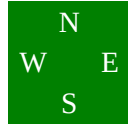


Board 2
East Deals
None Vul

♠ A 4 3
♥ J 10 2
♦ Q J 10 9 8
♣ A J

♠ K 10 8
♥ 7
♦ A 7 5 3 2
♣ 8 5 3 2



♠ 5
♥ K Q 9 6 3
♦ K 6
♣ K Q 10 9 6

♠ Q J 9 7 6 2
♥ A 8 5 4
♦ 4
♣ 7 4

West	North	East	South
		1 ♥	2 ♠
3 ♦	3 ♠	4 ♣	Pass
4 ♥	Pass	Pass	4 ♠
Dbl			
All Pass			

4 ♠ X by South
left with two losing ♥s and will be down 2. Without the two trump plays he could have ruffed all three of his ♥ losers and actually made the contract.

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 4 ♠ doubled

Lead the ♠ A.

South's 2 ♠ bid is a Weak-jump Overcall, based on a 6-card ♠ suit and a weak hand.

Either the ♦ Q or ♥ J would normally be good leads.

But on this deal North/South have clearly sacrificed against your almost certain ♥ game. Since they don't have enough high-card strength to make this contract declarer is hoping to get some ruffs.

The way to cut down the number of ruffs he can make is to lead a trump at every opportunity.

So take the ♠ A and then play another ♠. Declarer will still be able to ruff one ♥ in dummy, but will be

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 8 7 3
 ♥ Q 10 7 3
 ♦ 7 5
 ♣ 6 3 2

♠ 10 6 4

♥ 6 4 2

♦ K 9 4 2

♣ A K J



♠ Q 9 2

♥ K 8 5

♦ A 8 6

♣ 10 9 7 5

♠ A J 5

♥ A J 9

♦ Q J 10 3

♣ Q 8 4

West

North

East

South

Pass

3NT

1NT

All Pass

3NT by South
 cannot establish the ♠ winner.

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 3NT

Lead the ♥3, fourth highest in an attacking suit.

Sometimes it comes down to just this kind of choice.
 Do you lead fourth down from ♠ K 8 7 3 or from
 ♥ Q 10 7 3.

The presence of the ♥10 bolsters the ♥ suit enough
 to give it the edge.

The suits could be arranged something like shown at
 left. With a ♠ lead the presence of the ♠10 in
 dummy allows declarer to make a second ♠ trick,
 which happens to be declarer's ninth trick.

But when you lead the ♥3 it does not promote a ♥
 winner for declarer, and left to his own devices, he